



FREE · KEEP THIS ON THE DESK

# The Landlord's Schedule E Deduction Checklist

The write-offs landlords miss most, each mapped to the exact IRS line it belongs on. Tick what applies, then keep the receipt behind it. A record protects the number.

|                                                         |         |                                                          |         |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Advertising & listing fees     | line 5  | <input type="checkbox"/> Tenant screening & photos       | line 5  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Mileage, or actual auto costs  | line 6  | <input type="checkbox"/> Parking & tolls                 | line 6  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Routine cleaning & lawn care   | line 7  | <input type="checkbox"/> Pest control                    | line 7  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> HVAC service & gutters         | line 7  | <input type="checkbox"/> Leasing commissions             | line 8  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Landlord / liability insurance | line 9  | <input type="checkbox"/> Tax prep & legal for the rental | line 10 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Property manager or co-host    | line 11 | <input type="checkbox"/> Mortgage interest (Form 1098)   | line 12 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other loan interest            | line 13 | <input type="checkbox"/> Repairs: leaks, locks, paint    | line 14 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Supplies & small tools         | line 15 | <input type="checkbox"/> Property tax                    | line 16 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Licences & permits             | line 16 | <input type="checkbox"/> Electric / gas / water / trash  | line 17 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Internet you provide           | line 17 | <input type="checkbox"/> Depreciation of the building    | line 18 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Appliances & furniture         | line 18 | <input type="checkbox"/> Improvements (depreciated)      | line 18 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> HOA / condo fees               | line 19 | <input type="checkbox"/> Bank & payment fees             | line 19 |

MOST LOGBOOKS PRINT THIS WRONG

**2026 changed the mileage rate halfway through the year.**

72.5 cents a mile from 1 January to 30 June, then 76 cents from 1 July.  
IRS Announcement 2026-11. Total each half of the year separately.

Schedule E line numbers per the current IRS instructions. Not tax advice; some items depend on your situation.





BEFORE YOU FILE

# The call that most often goes wrong

## Repair, or improvement? line 14 against line 18

**REPAIR** deduct it now, line 14

Keeps the place in ordinary working order: fix a leak, replace a lock, patch drywall, a coat of paint.

**IMPROVEMENT** depreciate it, line 18

Betters, restores or adapts it: a new roof, an addition, a whole new HVAC system.

Getting this backwards is one of the most common rental audit issues. When unsure, ask your preparer, and stay consistent year to year.

## Your 2026 key dates

15 April 2026 File the 2025 return, Form 1040 with Schedule E. Q1 estimated tax due.

15 June 2026 Q2 estimated tax due.

15 September 2026 Q3 estimated tax due.

15 October 2026 Extended filing deadline, if you filed Form 4868.

15 January 2027 Q4 estimated tax due.

Estimated payments generally apply if you expect to owe \$1,000 or more for the year.



## This is one page. The whole year is a book.

The Rental Property Record Book: 94 pages built backwards from Schedule E. Rent roll, expense ledger, mileage, depreciation, and a year-end summary you copy straight onto your return.

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